



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Holy Family Academy

School Website: <https://holyfamilyacademy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Holy Family Academy in Manchester, NH (Holy Family Academy NH 03102) presents a cohesive, explicitly Catholic, classical-education model. Public-facing materials on the school's site emphasize a Catholic, liturgical identity; a curriculum rooted in the liberal arts and Great Books; and pedagogies that include Socratic discourse, rhetoric, and memorization (memory-work) within a traditional Trivium/Quadrivium framework. The school's philosophy foregrounds formation of virtue and character within a Catholic worldview and views parents as partners in a shared mission. Taken together, the public materials demonstrate a robust CLASSICAL orientation across all six rubric categories.

- Religious and metaphysical foundations are clearly anchored in Catholic theology and liturgical practice, with language about encounter with God, liturgy, the five marks of a Catholic school, and a Catholic worldview informing curriculum and community life. Evidence from the site includes explicit Catholic identity, liturgical prayer, catechesis, and a mission to form saints.
- The school's stated purpose centers on formation—virtue, wisdom, and the flourishing of the person—articulated in Catholic terms and aligned with the classical *paideia* (*paideia*, Great Books, permanent questions, love of learning).
- The curriculum is explicitly classical, emphasizing liberal arts (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric; quadrivium), Great Books, Latin, and integration of theology and philosophy. Public materials map to a Great Books–driven curriculum with primary texts.
- Pedagogy includes Socratic discussion in upper grades, seminars, and opportunities for rhetoric and public speaking; lower-grade elements imply chant/memory-based recall and communal practices. Evidence includes “Socratic method of teaching” and upper-school rhetoric/seminar activity.
- Faculty materials describe the leadership and staff as virtuous role models in a Catholic context; the site highlights faculty leadership and a “living curriculum” through a visible, faith-formed staff culture.
- Parents & Community material shows explicit partnership with families (parents as co-teachers; parent formation opportunities; parent involvement in events; shadow days; conferences). The site features admissions shadow days, parent orientation, and parent conferences, indicating ongoing parent engagement.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: explicit Catholic identity, liturgy, catechesis, and a mission to encounter God; five marks of Catholic school; Catholic worldview permeating curriculum.
- Positive keyword indicators include: Catholic, liturgy, theology, gospel, catechesis, living God, Christian anthropology, Catholic worldview, sacred tradition. Negative indicators are not evident in the public materials.
- Why CLASSICAL: The school presents transcendental moral realism and theology as foundational, with liturgical/community life integrated into education.
- Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: formation-focused aims (virtue, wisdom, human flourishing) and a pedagogy of contemplation/rest in alignment with *scholé* concepts; explicit aim to form saints within a Catholic framework.

- Positive keyword indicators include: formation, virtue, wisdom, contemplation, scholé, great conversation, human flourishing, moral imagination.
- Why CLASSICAL: The aims center on formation and the transcendentals (truth, good, beauty) rather than mere job preparation.
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: curriculum rooted in liberal arts (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric; quadrivium), heavy emphasis on Great Books, original texts, and the integration of theology/philosophy. 9th–12th grade examples include Great Books, Ancient History, Latin, geometry, biology with lab, and rhetoric.
- Positive keyword indicators include: liberal arts, trivium, quadrivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, primary sources, Western civilization, philosophy, theology, Latin.
- Why CLASSICAL: The curriculum aligns with the classical framework and the Great Books canon, not a modern social-studies- or STEM-first approach.
- Element 4: Pedagogy — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: explicit use of Socratic method in higher grades; seminars, debate, and rhetoric development; upper-level rhetoric theses; lower-grade memory-based elements (chanting, memorization) aligned with scholé pedagogy.
- Positive keyword indicators include: Socratic seminar, dialectic, disputation, narration, recitation, chanting, seminar, memory work, rhetoric, liturgical integration.
- Why CLASSICAL: The mix of contemplative/restful elements (scholé) and active Socratic/seminar learning matches classical pedagogy, with a sequence starting in K–8 (where applicable) and moving into high-school Socratic work.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: faculty leadership and credentials (Head of School, Dean of Academics) and explicit emphasis on faculty as a core element of the school's approach; faculty members are presented as mentors in a Catholic, classical environment.
- Positive keyword indicators include: living curriculum, mentors, masters, portrait of a teacher, collegial culture, faculty of friends; oath of fidelity to the Catholic Church for staff.
- Why CLASSICAL: The public materials frame faculty as virtuous exemplars and essential to the school's formation mission.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: explicit partnership with families and parent involvement (shadow days, parent orientation, parent conferences, admissions inquiries, and community events). The school also references formation of families within its program and ongoing parent involvement in school life.
- Positive keyword indicators include: partnership with families, parent formation, home-school collaboration, parent-teacher conferences, shadow day, open campus.
- Why CLASSICAL: The materials present parents as co-educators and integral to the classical project, consistent with the Six Elements' "partnership with families" and "formation of affections."

Overall aggregate rating: CLASSICAL

- The school demonstrates strong alignment with the Classical rubric across all six categories, with explicit evidence of Catholic metaphysical foundations, formation-focused aims, a liberal-arts curriculum centered on Great Books, Socratic and rhetorical pedagogy, a faculty described as mentors and living exemplars within a Catholic framework, and deep parent/community partnership.

What would move the needle

- Not applicable, as the school appears consistently CLASSICAL across all six categories based on the public materials available in the crawl.

ABSTRACT

Holy Family Academy (Manchester, NH) presents a robust CLASSICAL profile across all six classical-education criteria. Religious and metaphysical foundations are anchored in Catholic theology and liturgy; the school emphasizes formation, virtue, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty; curricular structure is classical (Trivium/Quadrivium) with extensive Great Books engagement; pedagogy includes Socratic seminars, rhetoric, and chant/memory practices; faculty are portrayed as virtuous mentors and living curriculum within a Catholic framework; and parents/community are engaged as co-educators through admissions processes, orientation, conferences, and ongoing involvement. The Positive keyword indicators consistently outweigh Negative indicators across the six categories, supporting a final classification of CLASSICAL for Holy Family Academy.

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Catholic identity, liturgy, catechesis, living God, gospel witness, Catholic worldview; strong theological grounding.
- Purpose and Goal: Formation, virtue, wisdom, contemplation (scholé), and the pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; human flourishing as telos.
- Curriculum: Liberal arts focus; trivium/quadrivium; Great Books; primary sources; Latin; history; philosophy; theology integration.
- Pedagogy: Socratic method; seminars; rhetoric; memory/chanting; contemplative/restful elements in pedagogy.
- Faculty: Model teachers/mentors; living curriculum; staff/faculty fidelity to Catholic mission; leadership roles.
- Parents & Community: Partnership with families; parent formation; shadow days; parent orientation; conferences; open-campus style events.

Note: All six categories were evaluated using keyword analyses aligned to the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) rubric, drawing from the school's public materials and the knowledge-base rubric. The school's materials show explicit presence of the core classical keywords (truth, virtue, Great Books, scholé, Socratic method, Great Conversation, liturgy, catechesis, etc.) in ways that align with the Positive keyword indicators defined in the classical-education lexicon, with minimal to no presence of the Negative keyword indicators in the public materials.

ABSTRACT (cont.)

- The school's public content demonstrates a coherent classical-education program under a Catholic framework, with formation and contemplation as core aims, classical curriculum and methods, a living-faculty model, and strong family-partnered community engagement. This culminates in a general assessment of CLASSICAL across all six classical-education categories.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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